

the timer, pose in front of it and the camera will automatically take a picture after the timer runs out.

The timer can also be used to take a picture without disturbing the camera. You can prop the phone somewhere and then to avoid shaking it while taking a picture, just use the timer instead.

Panorama mode

Panorama mode lets you take an extremely wide shot, also called a panorama. Since a camera cannot take such a wide shot by default, the way this feature works is by having you move the camera horizontally and the camera takes multiple photos and then stitches them together to form one single continuous shot.

Depending upon how good the camera software is at stitching, you may end up with unusable results or something that looks like it was shot at once rather than stitched together later. Some phones, such as the iPhone 5s do a brilliant job at this, stitching together multiple high resolution images while adjusting white balance and exposure for each to get a near perfect panorama. Others, not so much. Panoramas are a nice way to capture landscapes so give it a try next time instead of taking the same old boring photos.



Capture the world all at once

Now that we have talked about the camera software, let us take a look at some of the hardware. One of the most important aspects of any camera system is the lens. Two figures that worth talking about the lens is the focal length and the lens speed.

The focal length of a lens determines the amount of area it can capture. This number is usually measured in millimeters and you may find it written next to the lens as, say, 35mm. The smaller the focal length of a lens, the more area it can capture. So a wide angle lens will have lower focal length (usually 28mm) than a standard lens (35mm). Now a wide angle lens isn't always better. On phones, for example, where you cannot zoom in, having more area in your viewfinder means everything looks smaller than with a standard, non-wide lens. This means it works out well to capture wide